

Ashraellen - Grant Application Text Pack

Reusable grant language, research core and short descriptions

Short description

Ashraellen is a lifelong artistic-philosophical inquiry into meaning, perception, self-deception, inner freedom and the human loss of contact with reality. It works through books, novels, satire, essays, video, sound, symbolic analysis and a multilingual digital archive. These forms are not separate content products, but different ways of recording one long investigation.

Core statement

Ashraellen is not merely a name, but a mode of seeing.

It is a lifelong artistic-philosophical inquiry into meaning, perception, self-deception, inner freedom and the human loss of contact with reality. The work is based on the author's ability to perceive meanings inside meanings, structures within structures, and intersections where a casual phrase, an everyday scene, a personal reaction or a cultural form may reveal a deeper mechanism of human experience.

Ashraellen does not begin from the production of content. Books, essays, novels, videos, sound works, satire, symbolic analysis, public formulas and the multilingual archive are different forms of recording one long investigation.

At the centre of the project is the observation of how a human being replaces direct perception with interpretation; how pain becomes worldview; how fear turns into belief; how language, ideology, religion, digital pressure or personal trauma may begin to think in place of the person.

The author is present in this work not as the creator of a final system and not as the owner of truth, but as an observer and recorder of intersections. The purpose is not to offer a ready-made method of rescue, motivation or spiritual instruction, but to create forms through which a person may recognise mechanisms already active within themselves.

In this sense, Ashraellen functions as an independent artistic research practice, a literary and philosophical archive, and a multilingual public platform for the study of meaning, perception, attention, exhaustion, inner freedom and the contemporary loss of contact with reality.

One-paragraph grant version

Ashraellen is an independent artistic research practice and multilingual public archive created by Nikolai Kostyshev, an author living in Poland. The project investigates how a contemporary human being loses contact with reality, meaning and inner freedom, and how literary, satirical, visual, sound and digital forms can make these mechanisms visible. Support would provide a 12-month period of focused work to complete and prepare major literary projects, develop Ashraellen.com as a multilingual archive, translate and adapt key materials, and build a stable public structure for books, videos, texts, audio and audience response.

Why support is needed

Support is needed not for expansion for its own sake, but to stabilise the working conditions of an already existing research field. The project has grown across books, video, public texts, multiple languages and a dedicated website. Without support, the work remains split between creative research and external employment; with support, it can be systematised, completed, translated, archived and presented in a coherent public form.

Possible application phrases

- The project is not a content factory; it is a long-term artistic research practice that uses media forms as instruments of observation.
- The infrastructure serves the research: it allows existing work to be completed, preserved, translated and shared.
- The main public value is not simplification, but access: clearer entry points into complex artistic-philosophical work.
- Audience response is part of the field of research: recognition, resistance, gratitude and dispute become material for further observation.